

File Reference: .github/workflows/main-branch-gate.yml

A file-specific explanation covering purpose, owner layer, metadata, source details, implementation signals, source excerpts, and safe-change rules.

Item	Explanation
File	.github/workflows/main-branch-gate.yml
Category	GitHub workflow
Folder role	GitHub automation. GitHub Actions reads this during CI/release/branch-gate runs.
Size	1,259 bytes
Extension	.yml
MIME type	unknown
Text lines	40

Why this file exists

- GitHub Actions guard that rejects direct pushes to main and rejects pull requests into main unless the source branch is development.
- Workflow changes should be tested on a feature branch because mistakes can block merges or releases.

How it is used

GitHub automation. GitHub Actions reads this during CI/release/branch-gate runs.

How this file participates in the system

This generated section reads the actual file and points out line numbers, declarations, endpoints, events, source excerpts, and debugging cues.

Important implementation signals

Item	Explanation
Security or auth at line 11	Publishing protection, API key safety, HTTP security, or user authorization. Evidence: permissions:

Representative opening snippet

```
1: name: Main Branch Gate
2:
3: on:
4:   pull_request:
5:     branches:
6:       - main
7:   push:
8:     branches:
9:       - main
10:
11: permissions:
12:   contents: read
13:
14: jobs:
15:   require-development-source:
16:     name: Require development as the main source branch
17:     runs-on: ubuntu-latest
18:
19:     steps:
20:       - name: Verify main only receives development
21:         shell: bash
22:         env:
23:           HEAD_COMMIT_MESSAGE: ${ github.event.head_commit.message }
24:         run: |
25:           if [ "${ github.event_name }" = "push" ]; then
26:             if printf '%s' "$HEAD_COMMIT_MESSAGE" | grep -Eq '^Merge pull request #[0-9]+ from
[^/]+/development$'; then
27:               echo "main was updated by a development release PR."
28:               exit 0
29:             fi
```

```
30:
31:         echo "::error::Direct pushes to main are not allowed. Open a pull request from development
into main."
32:         exit 1
33:     fi
34:
35:     if [ "${{ github.head_ref }}" != "development" ]; then
36:         echo "::error::Pull requests into main must come from development. Merge this branch into
development first, test development, then open the development -> main release pull request."
37:         exit 1
38:     fi
39:
40:     echo "main release source is development."
```

Safe change checklist

- Confirm which app, website, installer, workflow, or document consumes this file.
- Change it on a feature branch from development.
- Regenerate docs if the file purpose, API surface, or behavior changes.
- Run the smallest relevant smoke test before merging into development.